

**Topic D2: Britain
and the Nationalist
Challenge in India,
1900-47**

between Britain and India in this period and on the reasons for this, with particular reference to Indian nationalism. Students will be expected to understand the importance of the growth and impact of Congress and the Muslim League as they challenged Britain's traditional role in India, and they should understand the reasons why India gained independence in 1947 and why independence led to partition.

It should be appreciated that the content bullet points should not be taken as discrete entities. There are many ways in which they impact upon each other and mesh together. Thus, for example, the Amritsar Massacre (bullet 2) had a considerable impact on recruitment to the Congress Party (bullet 3), attitudes of the British toward the Raj (bullet 1) resulted in the Rowlatt Acts (bullet 2) and there was a direct connection between Gandhi's satyagraha campaigns (bullet 3) and the 'Quit India' campaigns (bullet 4). Throughout, the tensions between Britain and the growing nationalism in India, exemplified by Congress and the Muslim League, drive the study.

The first bullet point relates to the importance of the Indian Empire to Britain and to the British economy. Students should know about the ways in which trade with India contributed to British economic prosperity and how Britain developed Indian agriculture and industry to foster this prosperity. The political importance of India to Britain should be understood, including the significance of making Queen Victoria Empress of India, and the 'jewel in the crown' concept. Students should know about the structure of British rule (the Raj) in India at the beginning of the 20th century and should understand the impact this had on relationships between Indians and British living in India and on the attitudes they held toward each other. Students are not required to know about the detail of the Morley-Minto reforms but they should understand their impact on British administrators in India and on Indians.

The second bullet point requires students to understand the significance of the impact of the First World War on the relationship between Britain and India. Students should know about the economic effects of the war on India and its political repercussions in that country. Although students are not expected to know the detail of the Montagu-Chelmsford Report and the Government of India Act of 1919, they are expected to understand why the Act was passed and the reaction to it in India. They should know about the Rowlatt Acts and the Amritsar Massacre and how these impacted on the relationship between Britain and India. They should understand why the 1920s was a period of retrenchment and re-grouping by both British and Indians and should know about the reasons for the failure of the Round Table Conferences in the 1930s.

The third bullet point relates to the rise of nationalism in India. Students should know how Congress developed into a political party with mass appeal and should understand the significance of the role of Gandhi in the satyagraha campaigns and the development of the idea of swaraj. They should understand why the Muslim League was formed and about the ways in which the League and Congress worked together and separately to attain their objectives. Students should know about the political leadership of Gandhi, Nehru and Jinnah in the years before the Second World War. They should understand how and why attitudes toward nationalism and independence changed and developed among the British and Indians living in the sub-continent.

The fourth bullet point requires students to understand how the Second World War impacted upon the relationship between Britain and India. They should know how Congress and the Muslim League reacted to the war, about Gandhi's 'Quit India' campaign and about the Lahore Declaration. Students should understand why the Cripps Mission failed. They should understand why, post-war, many of the British economic and political arguments for maintaining the Raj no longer held good. Students should know why the Cabinet mission failed. They should know about the role of Mountbatten and understand why Indian independence resulted in partition.